

AI-Assisted Alert Triage Report - 1083

Incident Information

Field	Value
Atomic Red Team Test	T1083 – File and Directory Discovery
Wazuh Rule ID	92052
Alert Severity	Level 4 (Medium)
Detection Source	Sysmon Event ID 1 – Process Creation
Host	AmnaNaeem
User	AMNANAEEM\amnanaeem
Detection Time	19 July 2026, 18:37:15 PKT

Executive Summary

A PowerShell process launched **cmd.exe**, which executed a series of Windows commands to enumerate files and directories across the system. The commands recursively listed files from the root drive, user directories, desktop, recent files, and Program Files, and saved the output to a temporary text file (**T1083Test1.txt**).

This behavior matches the **MITRE ATT&CK T1083 – File and Directory Discovery** technique, where an attacker searches the file system to identify valuable files, documents, or sensitive data before further actions such as collection or exfiltration.

Although Wazuh mapped the alert to **T1059.003 – Windows Command Shell**, analysis of the executed commands confirms that the underlying objective was **file and directory discovery**.

Alert Details

Item	Value
Rule ID	92052
Rule Description	Windows command prompt started by an abnormal process
Rule Level	4
Sysmon Event	Event ID 1 – Process Creation
Parent Process	powershell.exe
Child Process	cmd.exe
Integrity Level	High

MITRE ATT&CK Analysis

Wazuh Detection

Tactic	Technique	ATT&CK ID
Execution	Windows Command Shell	T1059.003

Human Verification (Correct Mapping)

The executed command was:

```
cmd.exe /c
dir /s C:\ >> %temp%\T1083Test1.txt
dir /s "C:\Documents and Settings" >> %temp%\T1083Test1.txt
dir /s "C:\Program Files\" >> %temp%\T1083Test1.txt
dir "%systemdrive%\Users\*.*" >> %temp%\T1083Test1.txt
dir "%userprofile%\AppData\Roaming\Microsoft\Windows\Recent\*.*" >>
%temp%\T1083Test1.txt
dir "%userprofile%\Desktop\*.*" >> %temp%\T1083Test1.txt
tree /F >> %temp%\T1083Test1.txt
```

These commands are designed to enumerate files and directories throughout the system.

Correct ATT&CK Mapping

Tactic	Technique	ATT&CK ID
Discovery	File and Directory Discovery	T1083
Execution	Windows Command Shell	T1059.003

Observation: Wazuh correctly detected the execution of `cmd.exe`, but it did not infer the higher-level discovery objective. Human analysis identifies the behavior as **T1083**.

Evidence Collected

Parent Process

powershell.exe

Child Process

cmd.exe

Executed Commands

- `dir /s C:\`
- `dir /s "C:\Documents and Settings"`
- `dir /s "C:\Program Files\"`
- `dir "%systemdrive%\Users\*.*"`

- `dir "%userprofile%\AppData\Roaming\Microsoft\Windows\Recent\*.*)"`
- `dir "%userprofile%\Desktop\*.*)"`
- `tree /F`

Output File

%TEMP%\T1083Test1.txt

User

AMNANAEEEM\amnanaeem

Integrity Level

High

Indicators Observed

The executed commands collected information about:

- Entire file system structure
- Installed applications
- User directories
- Desktop contents
- Recently accessed files
- Directory hierarchy
- File names and locations

The results were consolidated into a temporary text file for later review.

Security Analysis

The observed behavior is consistent with **File and Directory Discovery (MITRE ATT&CK T1083)**.

Adversaries commonly perform this activity after gaining initial access to identify valuable documents, credentials, configuration files, or other sensitive data. Saving the results into a text file is also a common reconnaissance technique before data collection or exfiltration.

In this environment, however, the activity was intentionally generated using Atomic Red Team as part of a controlled security validation exercise.

Risk Assessment

Category	Assessment
Severity	Medium (Level 4)
Confidence	High
Malicious	No (Lab Simulation)
False Positive	No
Expected Activity	Yes

Recommended Analyst Actions

If this alert occurred in a production environment:

1. Verify whether the file enumeration was authorized.
2. Identify who launched the PowerShell process.
3. Inspect the generated output file (`T1083Test1.txt`) for sensitive information.
4. Monitor for subsequent file collection or data exfiltration.
5. Correlate with additional discovery or credential access events.

For this lab:

- Confirm that the activity corresponds to the Atomic Red Team T1083 test.
- Record the detection as a successful validation of Sysmon and Wazuh monitoring.

AI vs Human Verification

Field	Wazuh Detection	AI Analysis	Human Verification
Rule ID	92052	92052	Correct
Severity	Level 4	Medium	Correct
Parent Process	powershell.exe	powershell.exe	Correct
Child Process	cmd.exe	cmd.exe	Correct
Executed Commands	Logged in Sysmon	dir, tree, recursive file and directory enumeration	Correct
Wazuh MITRE Technique	T1059.003 – Windows Command Shell	Identified as Windows command execution	Correct but incomplete
Actual Atomic Test	Not shown in the alert	T1083 – File and Directory Discovery	Correct
Threat Classification	Suspicious command execution	File and directory discovery activity in a controlled lab environment	Correct
Analyst Verdict	Requires investigation	Benign (Atomic Red Team simulation)	Confirmed

Final Verdict

Classification: Benign (Controlled Lab Activity)

Reason: The observed commands were intentionally executed by Atomic Red Team to simulate **MITRE ATT&CK T1083 – File and Directory Discovery**. Wazuh successfully detected the use of the Windows command shell and generated a process creation alert. Human analysis determined that the primary attacker objective was system-wide file and directory enumeration rather than command execution alone.

Human Verification Note

The alert was manually reviewed by analyzing the complete Sysmon process creation event and command line. The executed commands (dir and tree) confirmed **MITRE ATT&CK T1083 – File and Directory Discovery**. Wazuh mapped the event to **T1059.003** because it detected the execution of cmd.exe, not the higher-level objective. The activity matched the expected behavior of the Atomic Red Team simulation. Therefore, the incident was verified as a **benign laboratory test**, and the AI triage findings were confirmed with contextual refinement.